

Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System
Data retrieval system – Deployment and maintenance
instructions

29 May 2026

Data retrieval system

Deployment and maintenance instructions

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1 Purpose of the instructions

The purpose of these instructions is to provide guidance to data suppliers on deploying and maintaining a bank and payment accounts data retrieval system.

These instructions are supplemented by [the query interface description of the data retrieval system](#).

2 Glossary and abbreviations

Term	Description
Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System	The national Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System is based on the Finnish Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System (571/2019) and on Directive (EU) 2018/843 of the European Parliament and of the Council on the prevention of the use of the financial system for the purposes of money laundering or terrorist financing. In accordance with the legal amendment 863/2025, The Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System is composed of a centralised automated account information system and a centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system.
Data retrieval system	Data retrieval system refers to the electronic bank and payment accounts data retrieval system maintained by a data supplier. It enables the data supplier to transmit customer data and customers' account balance and transaction information referred to in chapters 2 and 3 of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, notwithstanding any secrecy provisions, to the competent authority. Data suppliers implement their own data retrieval systems, which means that there are several data retrieval systems. Finnish Customs determines the technical requirements for the data retrieval system.
Bank and Payment Accounts Register (Accounts Register)	The Bank and Payment Accounts Register (Accounts Register) is a system created by Finnish Customs that receives and stores the data referred to in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System. The Accounts Register consists of the Accounts Register application and its update and query interfaces. The Accounts Register is based on the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System (571/2019) and on Directive (EU) 2018/843 of the European Parliament and of the Council on the prevention of the use of the financial system for the purposes of money laundering or terrorist financing.

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Term	Description
Controller	In a data retrieval system, controllers are decentralised: a data supplier, as a controller, is responsible for the availability of data by maintaining a data retrieval system, and the competent authority, as a controller, is responsible for the data it processes through a data retrieval system.
Data supplier / party maintaining a data retrieval system	Data supplier / party maintaining a data retrieval system refers to a party maintaining its own data retrieval system referred to in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System that enables the data supplier to transmit customer data specified in the valid Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, without delay and notwithstanding any secrecy provisions, to the competent authority. Data supplier also refers to a Finnish branch office of a foreign payment institution, electronic money institution, credit institution or provider of crypto asset services.
Data user	Data user is the competent authority or bar association specified in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System that has the right to process data transmitted through the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System.
Testing	Testing refers to the testing of the interface of a data supplier's own data retrieval system. Testing ensures the functionality of at least all the data types that the data supplier will be submitting in production. The data supplier is responsible for creating the test material.
Maintenance	Maintenance refers to the data retrieval system maintenance processes, such as service level control, user support, disruption management, troubleshooting, access management as well as version and change management. The responsibility for these processes is decentralised. Customs is only responsible for issuing regulations concerning the technical requirements for data retrieval systems. Data suppliers maintaining data retrieval systems are responsible for the other processes.

3 Background and coverage

According to Directive (EU) 2018/843 of the European Parliament and Council, Member States are required to establish centralised automated mechanisms for accessing national information on the identity of holders of bank and payment accounts and safe-deposit boxes. Consequently, Finland has approved a national Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System (571/2019).

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In accordance with the legal amendment 863/2025, The Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System is composed of a centralised automated account information system and a centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system.

A centralised automated account information system refers to a centralised automated mechanism in accordance with to Directive (EU) 2018/843 of the European Parliament and Council, allowing for immediately access to data on bank and payment accounts data as well as safe-deposit boxes. A centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system refers to a EDP-based way to process account balance and transaction data from the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System as well as securities data.

The purpose of the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System is to facilitate authorities' automated access to information regarding bank and payment accounts as well as safe-deposit boxes, to facilitate authorities' electronic access to account balance and transaction information and securities information as well as to improve the data security for the personal data to be supplied.

Personal data in the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System are processed using the following:

- a bank and payment accounts data retrieval system
- the Bank and Payment Accounts Register (Accounts Register)
- a data disclosure system
- an aggregating application.

Through an electronic system, data can be accessed considerably faster than manually. Migrating to an electronic data transmission system will also enhance the data protection of businesses and citizens alike, as data are no longer submitted e.g. by fax. Another aim is to improve the data quality. Manual collection of data poses a greater risk of errors than what would occur in an automated process. In other words, data retrieved through the Bank And Payment Accounts Monitoring System are more reliable and accurate.

4 Description of the data retrieval system

Data retrieval systems are systems created by data supplier organisations. These systems enable data suppliers to transmit data on bank and payments accounts and their transactions and balances, safe-deposit boxes as well as securities to competent authorities.

Some of the operators are obligated to maintain a data retrieval system:

- Credit institutions are obligated to maintain their own data retrieval systems. Credit institutions can, however, ask the Financial Supervisory Authority for an exemption from this obligation. In practice, this means that the credit institution in question joins the Accounts Register maintained by Customs.
- Payment institutions, electronic money institutions and crypto-asset service providers can choose between joining the Accounts Register or implementing their own data retrieval system.

A data retrieval system comprises the data supplier's own systems, as well as the technical query interface defined by Customs. Customs issues a regulation concerning the data retrieval system and related interpretation guidelines, but each data supplier is responsible for the implementation of its data retrieval system.

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Data suppliers must submit an immediate and unfiltered response to any account information query made by a competent authority. Data suppliers must submit a response to an account balance and transaction information query no later than by the end of the following banking day.

Customs must be contacted (tilirekisteri@tulli.fi) before the implementation of a data retrieval system.

4.1 Data in a data retrieval system

A data retrieval system enables data suppliers to transmit data referred to in chapters 2 and 3 of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, notwithstanding any secrecy provisions, to the competent authority.

The data supplier, as a controller of a data retrieval system, is responsible for the availability of data by maintaining the data retrieval system. In turn, the competent authority, as a controller, is responsible for the data it processes using the data retrieval system. Both controllers have the obligation to oversee that data is processed lawfully.

Furthermore, according to the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, the competent authority must keep a log of the use of the data retrieval system that contains the minimum data specified in the Act.

4.1.1 Centralised automated account information system (Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, Chapter 2)

A centralised automated account information system refers to a centralised automated mechanism in accordance with Directive (EU) 2018/843 of the European Parliament and Council, allowing for immediate access to data on bank and payment accounts data as well as on safe-deposit boxes.

Data referred to in section 4 and, where applicable, in section 6 of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System must be transmitted through the data retrieval system.

Data must be transmitted if valid on 1 September 2020 or later. If the business under reporting obligation was started after 1 September 2020, the information must be submitted from the date of commencement of business.

Data on accounts or safe deposit boxes closed or customer relationships ended before 1 September 2020 should not be transmitted through the data retrieval system. Similarly, data on beneficiaries and other roles should not be transmitted if the role ended before 1 September 2020.

4.1.2 Centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system (Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, Chapter 3)

A centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system refers to a EDP-based way to process account balance and transaction data from the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System as well as securities data.

Provisions on data from the centralised electronic account balance and transaction information system are laid down in sections 17 b and 17 d of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System. Provisions on the time period regarding the data to be transmitted are laid down in section 17 f(2) of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System.

4.2 Responsibility for correctness of data

Data transmitted to data users through the data retrieval system are specified in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System.

Data suppliers are responsible for making sure that the data are correct and up-to-date. Data suppliers are obligated to prove that the data are accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date.

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Pursuant to the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), the controller has the obligation to demonstrate that the personal data are accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date. The controller must take every reasonable step to ensure that personal data that are imprecise and inaccurate, having regard to the purposes for which they are processed, are erased or rectified without delay ('accuracy').

The controller also has a notification obligation. The controller must communicate any rectification or erasure of personal data or restriction of processing to each recipient to whom the personal data have been disclosed. However, pursuant to the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, data subjects do not have the right to be informed of to which authorities their personal data have been disclosed. Due to this, to ensure the rights of the data subjects, the competent authority must also be notified if a data subject has contested the accuracy of their personal data. However, the competent authority has the right to use the personal data while the data supplier investigates the accuracy of the data.

4.3 Operators and roles

Data users are the competent authorities and the bar association that have the right to receive data specified in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System.

As a rule, credit institutions are responsible for implementing their data retrieval system interfaces. However, by an exemption granted by the Financial Supervisory Authority, a credit institution can join the Accounts Register, in which case it does not have to create its own data retrieval system.

As a rule, payment institutions, electronic money institutions and crypto-asset service providers have joined the Accounts Register. They can however, implement a data retrieval system interface.

Customs must be contacted (tilirekisteri@tulli.fi) before the implementation of a data retrieval system.

Table 1 Operators and roles relating to the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System interfaces

Operators	Operators implementing the data retrieval system interface	Data users of the data retrieval system
Competent authorities and the bar association		X
Credit institutions	A	
Payment institutions	B	
Electronic money institutions	B	
Crypto-asset service providers	B	

X) always

A) as a rule

B) by notification

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Data suppliers must submit the data specified in the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System notwithstanding any secrecy provisions to competent authorities through the data retrieval system.

Data suppliers are divided into two categories:

- category 1: credit institutions
- category 2: payment institutions, electronic money institutions and crypto-asset service providers

The use cases of these categories are described in more detail in the interface description of the data retrieval system.

The query interface of the data retrieval system must be implemented according to the interface description specified by Customs. The query interface will be implemented using SOAP/XML Web Service technology.

See the instructions for the technical implementation of the data retrieval system and for the query interface messages:

- [Query interface description of the data retrieval system](#)
- [description of the centralised account balance and transaction information system](#).

6 Regulation and notification procedure

Customs issues a regulation and instructions for implementing the query interface of the data retrieval system.

Customs must be contacted regarding the implementation of the data retrieval system. This applies to credit institutions as well as payment institutions, electronic money institutions and crypto-asset service providers that create their own data retrieval systems.

Customs will inform the competent authorities, i.e. the data users, of any changes to the data suppliers that have created their own data retrieval systems.

Even if an operator has joined the Accounts Register, it can later implement a data retrieval system and migrate to using it. Customs must be notified of the change. After this, Customs will send the regulation concerning the query interface of the data retrieval system and the related instructions, so that the operator can implement a data retrieval system. Once the operator notifies Customs that the query interface of the data retrieval system is completed and tested, Customs will close the operator's update interface for the Accounts Register. The same procedure applies to credit institutions that have joined the Accounts Register by an exemption granted by the Financial Supervisory Authority, as well as payment institutions, electronic money institutions and crypto-asset service providers that create their own data retrieval systems.

In unclear situations, you will receive further instructions and support from Customs:
tilirekisteri@tulli.fi.

7 Data security

The data security of the data retrieval system is based on the protection of the data connections using TLS encryption. The data exchange parties identify each other with server certificates. In addition, the messages follow a standard protocol and are digitally signed.

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The connections of the data retrieval system must be protected with TLS encryption using version 1.2 or later of the TLS protocol. Both ends of the connection are identified with server certificates using two-way handshaking. The server certificate requirements are specified in section 7.1 of this document as well as in the query interface description of the data retrieval system.

The message content must be signed as SOAP XML records using signature certificates. The signature certificates are described in detail in section 7.1 and in the query interface description.

7.1 Certificate requirements

The external connections of the data retrieval system are secured through certificates. Data suppliers of the data retrieval system must obtain and install a server certificate that meets the certificate requirements. In addition, a signature certificate is required for signing the messages.

Technically, an individual certificate can be used as both a server and a signature certificates, or the certificates can be separate. Typically, server certificates are installed in front-end servers that administer data communications, whereas signature certificates are installed in back-end servers that generate responses.

Certificates are to be acquired by the party that generates and transmits responses to queries submitted by data users. If a data supplier uses a service provider for building and transmitting messages on behalf of the data supplier, the server certificate is to be acquired by the service provider. In such cases, the data supplier must authorise the service provider to sign the messages to be sent.

7.2 Renewal of certificates

Certificates must be renewed in good time before their expiry. An expired certificate cannot be used.

Check the query interface description of the data retrieval system for up-to-date certificate requirements.

According to section 1 f of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System, the competent authority has the right to obtain data free of charge, which means that data suppliers are responsible for the costs relating to the certificates they use.

8 Stages of deployment

The deployment of the data retrieval system involves testing, opening of data connections as well as approval of the deployment.

The data supplier is responsible for its own applications, services and for data connections as well as for the costs these incur to the own organisation or to any third parties whose services may be required for the deployment. The data message structure must be implemented according to the interface description specified by Customs.

Data suppliers must assign a contact person in their organisations, who will act as the primary contact person in transactions with Finnish Customs regarding deployment and maintenance of the data retrieval system.

8.1 Testing

Customs tests the integration to each data supplier separately. Customs coordinates the testing in cooperation with the data supplier.

The functioning of the data retrieval system interface is tested by submitting API queries from Customs' customer environment to the data supplier's system and by verifying the responses received.

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The purpose of the testing is to ensure the functionality of at least all the data types that the data supplier will be submitting in production. The data supplier is responsible for creating the test material. The test material must not contain any real data, such as names or account details of natural persons.

Before starting production use, the functionality of connections is also ensured in production.

8.2 Approval

Once the tasks related to the deployment of the data retrieval system have been carried out and tested, Customs approves the move into production with a written notification.

8.3 Disruptions

Data suppliers must submit an immediate and unfiltered response to any account information query (Chapter 2 of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System) made by a competent authority (data user). Data suppliers must submit a response to an account balance and transaction information query (Chapter 3 of the Act on the Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System) no later than by the end of the following banking day. The query interface of the data retrieval system must be available at all times.

The data supplier and Customs must inform other concerned parties without delay about malfunctions in their service that affect the functionality of the query interface. The data supplier must also inform Customs of any planned maintenance and downtime that may affect the query interface or the supply of data.

8.4 Change management

Customs updates the query interface description of the data retrieval system if there are changes to the interfaces. Customs also directly notifies the contact persons appointed by data suppliers of any changes.

If you notice something that needs changing in the query interface of the data retrieval system, you can send your proposed change sent by email to Customs ([tilirekisteri\(at\)tulli.fi](mailto:tilirekisteri(at)tulli.fi)).

8.5 Support provided by Customs

Customs provides support regarding the deployment, operational models and contents of data retrieval systems.

- Please first check the guidance on the Customs website: [Bank and Payment Accounts Monitoring System](#)
- You can also contact Customs by email: tilirekisteri@tulli.fi.